

Enterprise

Prospecting Playbook

A structured, repeatable framework for identifying, engaging, and converting high-value enterprise opportunities from first signal to first meeting.

- P** The Enterprise Seller's Mindset
- 01** Research & Account Intelligence
- 02** Call Preparation & the 3x3 Framework
- 03** Outreach Strategy & Sequencing
- 04** The 5-15-3 Prospecting Model
- 05** Mutual Success Planning
- 06** Deal Orchestration & the Digital Deal Room

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Frameworks referenced herein draw upon concepts from the Sandler Selling System®, the Challenger Sale™ (Gartner), and the MEDDIC/MEDDPIC qualification methodology. All third-party frameworks are the intellectual property of their respective owners and are referenced for educational purposes only.

PRINCIPLES

The Enterprise Seller's Mindset

Frameworks and tools are only as good as the mindset behind them.

Be Prepared, Not Lucky	Every great call is 90% preparation. Prospects can feel the difference between a rep who did the work and one who winged it. Preparation is respect.
Earn the Right to Advance	Never push for next steps you haven't earned. Move forward when the customer gives you a signal, not because your CRM says a deal should close this quarter.
Your Champion Wins with You	The best enterprise sellers make their champion look like a hero internally. Their success is your success. Protect them, arm them, and never put them in a position they can't defend.
Silence Is a Signal	When a deal goes quiet, something changed internally. Don't wait. Investigate. A week of silence is a warning. Two weeks is a problem. Three weeks is a lost deal you didn't know was lost.
Own the Process or It Owns You	In complex enterprise deals, someone is always in control of the buying process. Make sure it's you, by defining next steps, owning the MSP, and keeping both sides accountable.
Data Over Intuition, Curiosity Over Assumptions	Build your business cases on the customer's own numbers. Ask more questions than you answer. The reps who ask the best questions close the most deals.

This playbook represents my personal approach to enterprise prospecting, built over 10+ years of selling complex SaaS into Fortune 1000 organizations. Every framework here has been tested in the field and refined through real deals.

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01 RESEARCH

Research & Account Intelligence

Before the first call is made, world-class enterprise sellers know more about their prospect than most internal employees. Research transforms cold outreach into credible, contextualized conversations.

TIER 1: COMPANY-LEVEL INTELLIGENCE

Business Context

- Annual report / 10-K highlights
- Revenue, growth trajectory, strategic priorities
- Recent earnings calls and analyst commentary
- Active M&A;, expansions, or restructuring

Technology Landscape

- Current tech stack (CRM, ERP, cloud infrastructure)
- Recent IT investments or digital transformation signals
- Open engineering/IT/data job postings
- Gartner/Forrester analyst placements

TIER 2: STAKEHOLDER INTELLIGENCE

Executive Mapping

- Identify CIO, CTO, CFO, COO, CDO, CSCO
- Map reporting lines and influence paths
- Review LinkedIn activity, posts, interviews
- Conference talks, published articles, board roles

Champion Identification

- VP/Director level operational buyers
- Recent hires signaling new initiatives
- Internal advocates connected to your network
- Shared connections for warm introduction paths

TIER 3: TRIGGER EVENTS

News & Signals

- Funding rounds or IPO activity
- Executive leadership changes
- New product launches
- Regulatory or compliance changes

Competitive Intel

- Known incumbent vendors at risk
- Competitive displacement opportunities
- Market share shifts in their vertical
- RFP activity via public channels

Relationship Signals

- Mutual connections on LinkedIn
- Conference attendance overlap
- Alumni networks or shared vendors
- Partner ecosystem referrals

02 CALL PREP

Call Preparation & the 3x3 Framework

The 3x3 framework is a structured pre-call research discipline: identify 3 meaningful insights about a prospect in 3 minutes or less. Used consistently, it raises the quality of every first conversation.

3 INSIGHTS	IN 3 MINUTES
Business Insight • A recent strategic priority or announced initiative • Revenue milestone, growth target, or announced challenge • Key vertical trend that is reshaping their industry	Personal Insight • Prospect's recent LinkedIn post, article, or panel talk • Published thought leadership or conference keynote topic • Career history signals that reveal current priorities
Shared Context • Mutual connection, shared vendor, or ecosystem partner overlap • Alumni network, industry event, or community connection • Reference customer in the same vertical, segment, or use case	

PRE-CALL CHECKLIST		
✓ Research complete (3x3 done)	✓ Hypothesis on pain/initiative formed	✓ Personalized opener drafted
✓ Value hypothesis tied to their KPIs	✓ Objection responses prepared	✓ Next step / CTA defined

03 OUTREACH

Outreach Strategy & Sequencing

Effective enterprise outreach is multi-channel, personalized, and persistent without being aggressive. Each touch builds on the last, educating, provoking thought, and creating a reason to respond.

1	Day 1	LinkedIn connection request with personalized note referencing a specific insight
2	Day 3	Email #1: Personalized opener tied to a business trigger or initiative
3	Day 7	Phone call + voicemail referencing the email and adding a new data point
4	Day 10	Email #2: Share a relevant case study, benchmark, or industry insight
5	Day 14	LinkedIn message: Comment on their recent post or share relevant content
6	Day 18	Email #3: The breakup email, clear value prop + easy CTA + graceful exit

CHANNEL MIX GUIDANCE

Email • Subject line = your best asset • One clear idea per email • Shorter is better, 4 sentences max • Always end with a low-friction CTA	Phone / Voicemail • 15-second voicemail max • Reference the email by name • Add one new data point not in email • Give your number twice, slowly	LinkedIn • Engage with content before connecting • Reference something specific they posted • Use InMail sparingly, save for highest value targets • Build a reputation before you sell
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04 5-15-3

The 5-15-3 Prospecting Model

The 5-15-3 model provides a structured daily discipline for maintaining a healthy, self-sufficient pipeline. It balances top-of-funnel activity with focused execution on your highest-potential accounts.

5

Target Accounts Actively Worked
Daily

15

Outreach Touches Completed Per
Day

3

New Conversations Opened Per
Week

- The 5: Your Focus Accounts**

 - 5 high-priority accounts get daily attention
 - Each has a defined hypothesis and next action
 - Rotated weekly based on engagement signals
 - Prioritized by trigger events, fit score, and timing
 - Never let a day pass without a touch on each
- The 15: Daily Activity**

 - Mix of email, phone, LinkedIn, and video
 - Not spray-and-pray, each touch is intentional
 - Tracked in CRM with outcome and next step
 - Cadence tools (Outreach, Salesloft) support automation
 - Quality over quantity, relevance drives response rate

- The 3: Weekly Conversations**

 - 3 new first conversations opened per week is the benchmark for a healthy pipeline
 - A 'conversation' = any two-way exchange that advances qualification or sets a next step
 - Track conversion rate from touch to conversation weekly and adjust mix accordingly
 - If below 3, diagnose: wrong personas, weak messaging, or insufficient volume
 - If above 3 consistently, you are building pipeline ahead of quota, protect that time

PIPELINE HEALTH BENCHMARKS

Metric	Target	Warning Sign
Pipeline Coverage	3-4x quota	Below 3x heading into a quarter
Avg. Deal Age	Aligned to avg. sales cycle	Deals lingering 2x past avg. cycle
Stage Conversion Rate	Track weekly by stage	Piling in mid-stage with no progression
New Opps Added / Week	2-3 qualified new opps	Zero new opps added for 2+ weeks

05 SUCCESS PLANNING

Mutual Success Planning

A Mutual Success Plan (MSP) is a co-created, living document that aligns both the seller and the buyer on outcomes, timelines, and responsibilities. It transforms a sales process into a shared project and dramatically improves forecast accuracy and deal velocity.

WHEN TO INTRODUCE THE MSP

Introduce the MSP after discovery is complete and mutual interest is established, typically at the point of technical evaluation or executive alignment. Framing: *"I'd like to suggest we build a shared success plan together so we both have clarity on what a great outcome looks like and what it takes to get there."*

THE 6 COMPONENTS OF AN EFFECTIVE MSP

1. Agreed Business Outcomes

- What does success look like 6 and 12 months post-deployment?
- Specific, measurable KPIs tied to the customer's strategic priorities
- Quantified ROI target co-developed with the economic buyer

2. Decision Criteria & Process

- Who are all the stakeholders involved in the decision?
- What does each stakeholder need to feel confident?
- What is the formal approval and legal/procurement process?

3. Technical Evaluation Plan

- Defined scope and success criteria for any POC or pilot
- Named technical owners on both sides
- Clear timeline with go/no-go milestone

4. Implementation Roadmap

- Phased deployment plan with week-by-week milestones
- Resource commitments from the customer's side
- Named implementation sponsor and executive champion

5. Risk Register

- What could slow or derail this deal?
- Proactive plan for each identified risk
- Contingency options if timelines shift

6. Signature & Launch Timeline

- Target contract execution date (backwards from desired go-live)
- Legal, security, and procurement lead times built in
- Internal launch and enablement plan post-signature

Why the MSP Wins Deals

- Separates serious buyers from tire-kickers, champions will engage, skeptics will stall
- Creates internal urgency by tying your deal to the customer's own stated priorities and timelines
- Reduces late-stage surprises by surfacing procurement, legal, and security requirements early
- Gives your champion a tool to sell internally on your behalf when you are not in the room
- Improves forecast accuracy, deals with a signed MSP close at a significantly higher rate

ORCHESTRATION

Deal Orchestration & the Digital Deal Room

Enterprise deals involve multiple stakeholders, extended timelines, and significant internal complexity on the buyer's side. Deal orchestration is the discipline of coordinating all moving parts, people, content, process, and technology, to drive alignment and momentum from both sides of the table.

THE DEAL ORCHESTRATION FRAMEWORK

1	2	3	4
Map the Organism	Align Internal Pod	Create Momentum	Control the Room
Build a full stakeholder map: economic buyer, technical buyer, champion, influencers, and blockers	Coordinate your own team: AE, SE, CSM, legal, exec sponsor, everyone has a role and owns it	Use MSP milestones, exec briefings, and reference calls to keep both sides moving in parallel	Own every next step, never leave a meeting without a defined action, owner, and date

THE DIGITAL DEAL ROOM

A Digital Deal Room is a centralized, shared workspace that gives both the seller's team and the buyer's team a single place to collaborate, access content, track milestones, and communicate throughout the sales cycle. It replaces the chaos of fragmented email threads and Dropbox folders with a structured, professional experience that reflects the quality of your platform. My live deal room example can be viewed at: buyersagent.netlify.app

What Lives in the Deal Room

- Executive summary and value proposition
- ROI model and business case documents
- Mutual Success Plan with live milestone tracking
- Technical evaluation criteria and results
- Case studies and reference customer stories
- Contract and legal documents (when appropriate)
- Meeting recordings and follow-up notes

The Business Case for a Deal Room

- Professionalizes the buying experience from day one
- Keeps your champion armed with the right content at all times
- Creates a single source of truth, no version confusion
- Surfaces buyer engagement signals (who viewed what, when)
- Accelerates procurement by housing all required documentation
- Demonstrates operational excellence before the contract is signed

Deal Room Best Practices

- Introduce the deal room at or before the first executive meeting, it sets a professional tone immediately
- Customize the welcome message and cover page for each specific account and stakeholder
- Keep content organized by stage: Discovery, Evaluation, Business Case, Legal/Procurement, Launch
- Review engagement analytics weekly, a buyer who stops engaging is a deal at risk
- Use the deal room link in all email correspondence to reinforce it as the single source of truth
- Align deal room milestones directly to the Mutual Success Plan for a seamless buyer journey